

Ministry of Forests, Lands, Natural Resource Operations and Rural Development

High Streamflow Advisory – South Coast and Vancouver Island

ISSUED: 2:00PM April 1, 2022

The River Forecast Centre is issuing a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- **Howe Sound (Sea-to-Sky Corridor)**
- **Sunshine Coast**
- **North Shore Mountains**
- **Metro Vancouver**
- **Fraser Valley including the Chilliwack River and surrounding tributaries**
- **West Vancouver Island**
- **East Vancouver Island**
- **South Vancouver Island**
- **Central Vancouver Island**

A significant weather pattern shift is expected to impact south-west British Columbia over the upcoming weekend. Environment and Climate Change Canada has issued a Special Weather Statement for Heavy Rain from Sunday morning to Monday morning for areas on the Sunshine Coast, Sea-to-Sky Corridor, the North Shore Mountains, Metro Vancouver, and the Lower Fraser Valley. Most recent weather model results forecast precipitation totals of 40 to 80 mm for the Sunshine Coast and Howe Sound, 40 to 80 mm for Metro Vancouver, and 100 to 150 mm for the North Shore Mountains. Vancouver Island could experience relatively high rainfall, with coastal sections reaching 100 to 150 mm total and 30 to 75 mm over central and eastern portions of the island. There is still high uncertainty in precipitation totals as the event is several days out. Freezing levels will range from 1,200 to 1,500 m through the event. Colder air will arrive Monday and drop freezing levels to 1,000 m. Precipitation occurring next week will likely fall as snow in the mountains.

River Forecast Centre hydrological models are showing the potential for significant increases if the forecasted precipitation occurs. Current streamflow in rivers and creeks are normal to

Ministry of Forests, Lands, Natural Resource Operations and Rural Development

above normal for this time of year due to warm weather over the past few days which melted lower elevation snow. Baseflow conditions through winter and into spring have been relatively high due to the extreme rainfall in late 2021. The upcoming system is not as strong as the atmospheric rivers that occurred in November, but it is a potent storm for April. Primary concerns will be for smaller and lower elevation rivers. Based on the current weather forecast, flows will rise rapidly on Sunday and into Monday, with peaks likely occurring throughout Monday.

The incoming direction of the storm system is expected to be southwesterly and not directly funneling up the Coquihalla like the November 13-15 event. The forecast precipitation for the Coquihalla Summit is 20-40 mm.

The public is advised to stay clear of the fast-flowing rivers and potentially unstable riverbanks during the high-streamflow period.

The [River Forecast Centre](#) continues to monitor the conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

BC River Forecast Centre

Ministry of Forests, Lands, Natural Resource Operations and Rural Development

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.